

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Title

Women-Led Agro-Processing Enterprises and Low-Productivity Traps in Ghana

Author

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Overview

This project examines whether women-led agro-processing enterprises in Ghana remain concentrated in persistent low-productivity conditions despite growing policy attention to women's entrepreneurship and enterprise upgrading. The empirical motivation is that agro-processing is often treated as a promising pathway for value addition and inclusive growth, yet many women-operated firms continue to face weak productivity, limited formalization, and fragile continuity of operations.

Data

The analysis uses pooled microdata from the Ghana Annual Household Income and Expenditure Survey (AHIES) 2022, 2023, and 2024, a nationally representative high-frequency household panel survey implemented by the Ghana Statistical Service. The project harmonizes differences in file type, variable storage, coding conventions, and industry classifications across the three waves before constructing a pooled analytic sample of adult non-farm enterprise workers.

Methods

The workflow combines multi-year survey harmonization, variable construction, descriptive diagnostics, and pooled OLS regression analysis. The main empirical specification relates weekly hours worked in non-farm enterprise activity to agro-processing status, enterprise formality, gender, age, education, and survey year, with an additional triple interaction used to assess gender heterogeneity in the agro-formality relationship.

Contribution

The project contributes a reproducible microdata workflow for studying women-led enterprise performance in Ghana and provides an empirical framework for distinguishing between ordinary firm-level constraints and deeper coordination-type low-productivity traps.

Software

Stata 16; Git/GitHub workflow.